

HR-207 Remote and Hybrid Working

Policy ID: HR-207 Version: 4.2 Classification: Internal
Effective Date: 1 January 2026 Owner: People Operations
Applies to: All permanent and fixed-term employees

1 Purpose and Scope

This policy sets out the company's approach to working from home and to hybrid and remote working arrangements. It explains who may work remotely, how much of the week may be worked away from the office, and the conditions that apply when an employee does so.

2 Definitions

- Hybrid working means an employee divides their working week between a company office and a remote location, normally their home
- Fully remote working means an employee has no regular office attendance requirement and their contractual place of work is their home
- Occasional home working means an employee works from home on an ad hoc day by agreement with their manager

3 Eligibility

Hybrid working is available to all employees whose role can be performed effectively away from the office. Roles that require a physical presence, such as facilities, reception, and laboratory work, are identified as office-based in the job description and are not eligible.

Employees in their first four weeks of employment work from the office full time, so that induction, equipment setup, and initial supervision can be completed in person.

4 Working Arrangements

4.1 Team Working Agreements

Each team publishes a written working agreement stating its anchor days, its core collaboration hours, and how meetings are run so that remote attendees can participate fully. The agreement is reviewed every six months.

4.2 Working from Home and Remote Work Arrangements

Employees eligible for hybrid working may work from home for up to three days in each week and must attend a company office for a minimum of two days in each week. Tuesday and Wednesday are anchor days on which the whole team is expected to be in the office together, and the remaining office day, where required, is agreed with the manager.

An employee may work remotely on a given day provided all of the following conditions are met. The manager has agreed the pattern in advance and it is recorded in the human resources system. The employee is contactable and available for meetings throughout core hours. The work planned for that day does not require physical presence, access to restricted hardware, or handling of material classified as confidential in hard copy. The employee has a safe and suitable workspace and a broadband connection sufficient for video calls.

Fully remote arrangements are granted by exception. A fully remote arrangement requires a business case from the manager and approval from the relevant director, is reviewed every twelve months, and may be withdrawn with three months of written notice where the business need changes. An employee seeking to change their contractual place of work permanently should instead make a flexible working

request under the flexible working policy, reference HR-204.

Remote work must be performed from the employee's country of employment, because working from another country affects tax residency, social security, and the company's insurance cover. Working abroad temporarily is permitted for up to twenty working days in any leave year, and requires written approval from the employee's manager and People Operations before travel is booked.

A manager may require an employee to attend the office on a day that would otherwise be worked remotely, where there is a specific business need such as a customer visit, a team planning session, or an onboarding week. Reasonable notice of at least three working days will be given wherever possible.

4.3 Equipment and Expenses

The company provides a laptop, a monitor, a keyboard, and a mouse for home use. Employees may claim a one-off home office allowance towards a desk and chair, and the amount is published on the intranet and reviewed annually. Broadband and utility costs are not reimbursed. Expenses are claimed under the expenses policy.

5 Health, Safety and Data Security

Employees working from home complete a workstation self-assessment annually. Company data may only be accessed on company-provided equipment, over the company virtual private network, and never on public or unsecured wireless networks. Confidential information must not be printed at home. Any suspected data incident must be reported to the security team on the same day.

6 Review

People Operations reviews this policy annually, and earlier where legislation or business circumstances change.